

Welcome To  
**- MICROVILLE -**

**The Tiny Town Where  
Everyone Belongs!**



Written & Illustrated by  
**Bahareh Rahimi  
Shahmirzadi**

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1. **Introduction**  
 2. **Background**  
 3. **Methodology**  
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**Dedicated to every child who  
has ever wondered if they belong.**

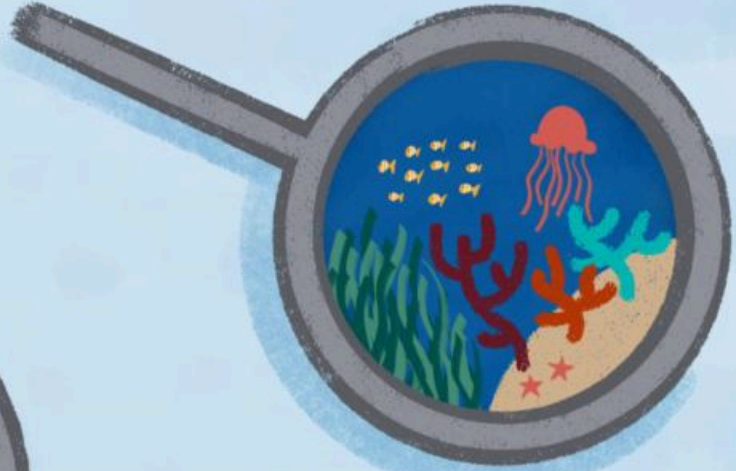
**May you always remember that  
being different is something to  
celebrate, and that there is a place  
for you wherever you go.**

**Mimi loved exploring the world around her...**



**She explored forests.**

**She explored oceans.**



**She explored the stars.**



**But there was one place  
she had never explored...**



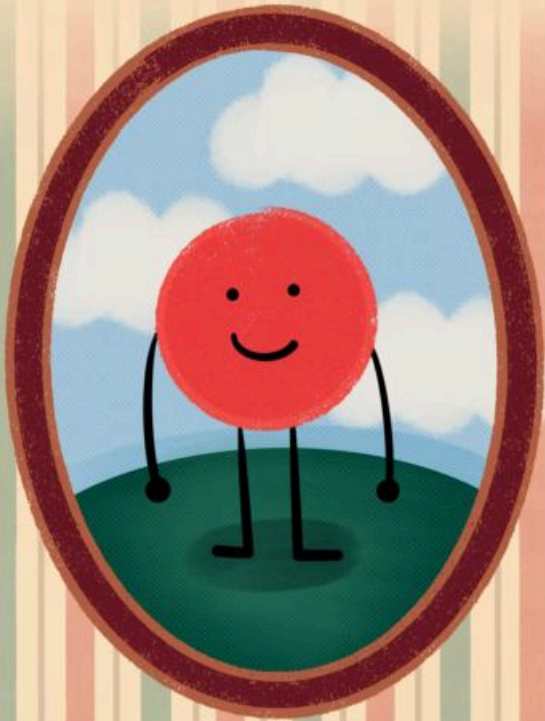
**THE DINNER TABLE!!!!**

**So Mimi and her dad visited the pediatrician.  
“Why does Mimi have trouble trying new foods?” he asked.  
The doctor smiled and whispered:  
“Maybe it’s time you met some of the tiny helpers who  
live in a secret city inside you...”**

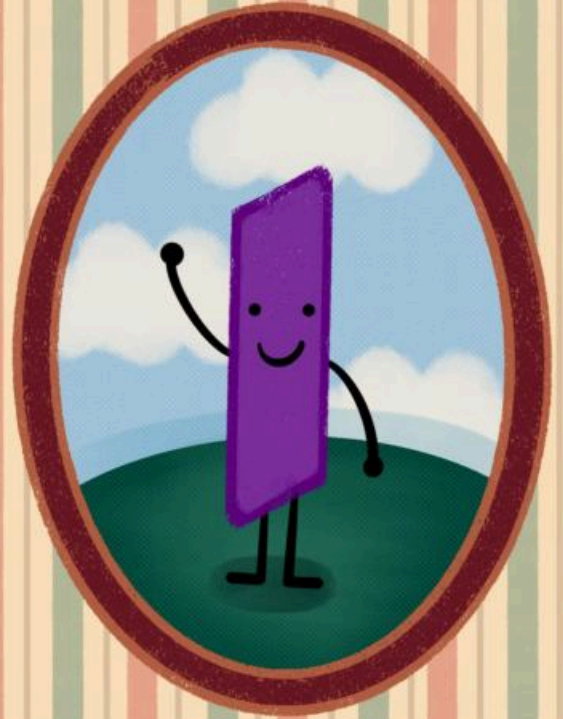
**“Inside your gut is a tiny community called MicroVille.”  
“It is home to trillions of microbes!”**



**MicroVille was filled with neighbours  
of all shapes and sizes...**



**Some were round.**



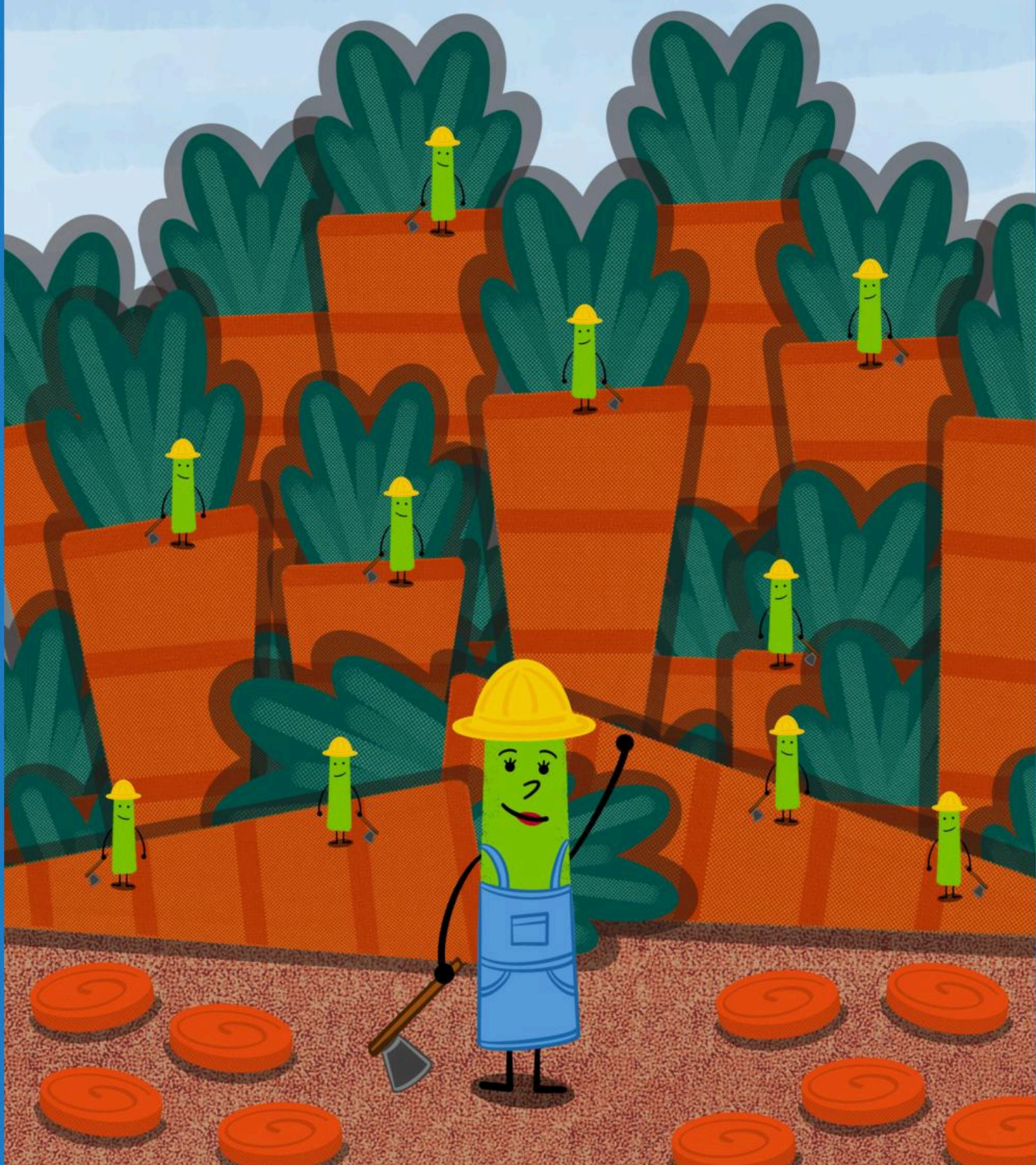
**Some were long.**



**Some were twisty.**

**No two microbes looked exactly alike.**

**“This is Fiona Fiber,” said the doctor. “She loves the foods that come from plants!” Fiona turned fiber into things that kept MicroVille healthy.**



**“This is Vita Vitamin!”**

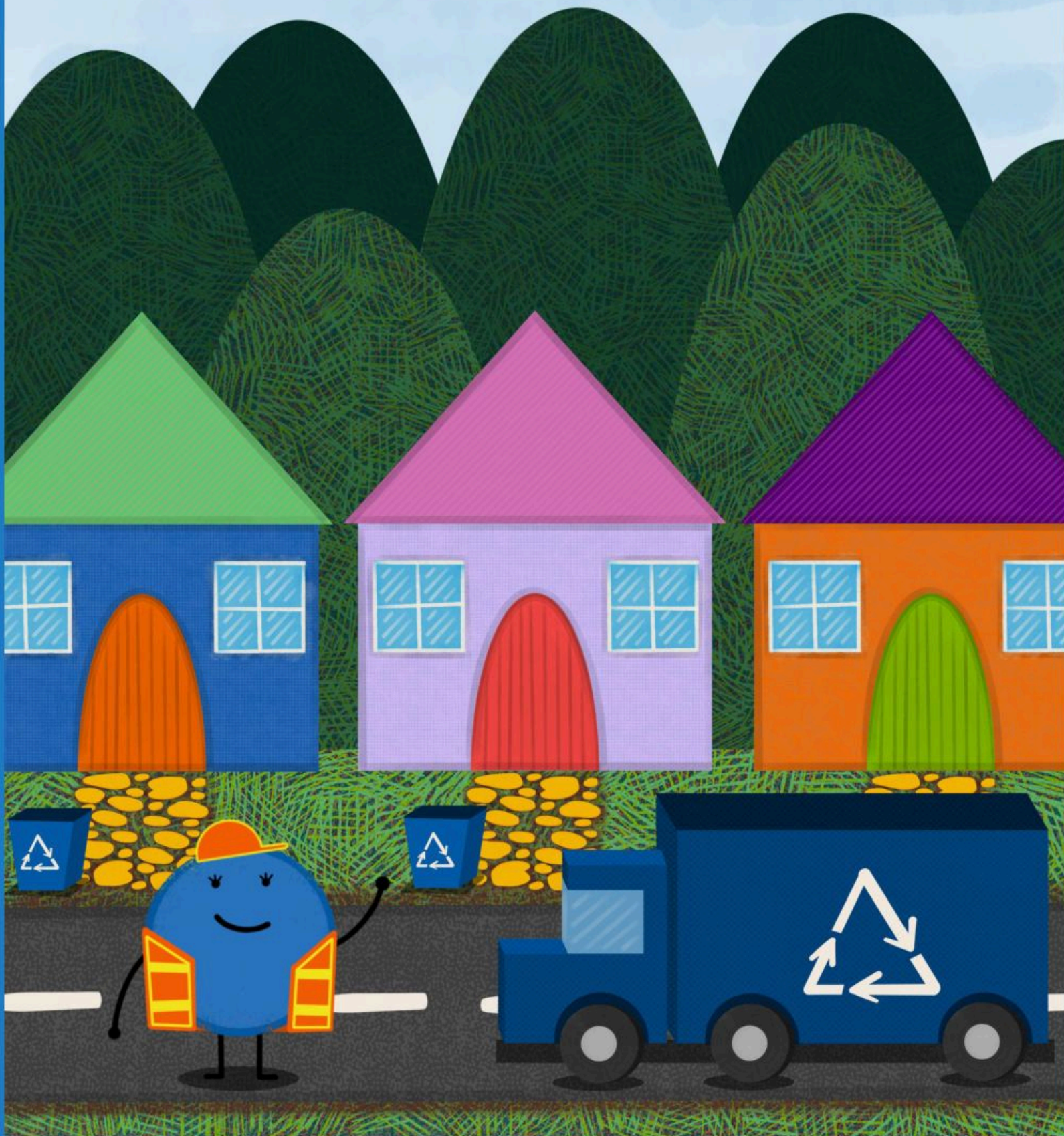
**“She helps make important vitamins that Mimi’s body can use.”**



**“This is Penny Protector!”**  
**“She helps keep MicroVille in balance by**  
**making it harder for harmful**  
**microbes to take over.”**



**“This is Cleo Clean-Up!”**  
**“She helps recycle leftovers and**  
**keeps the city running smoothly.”**

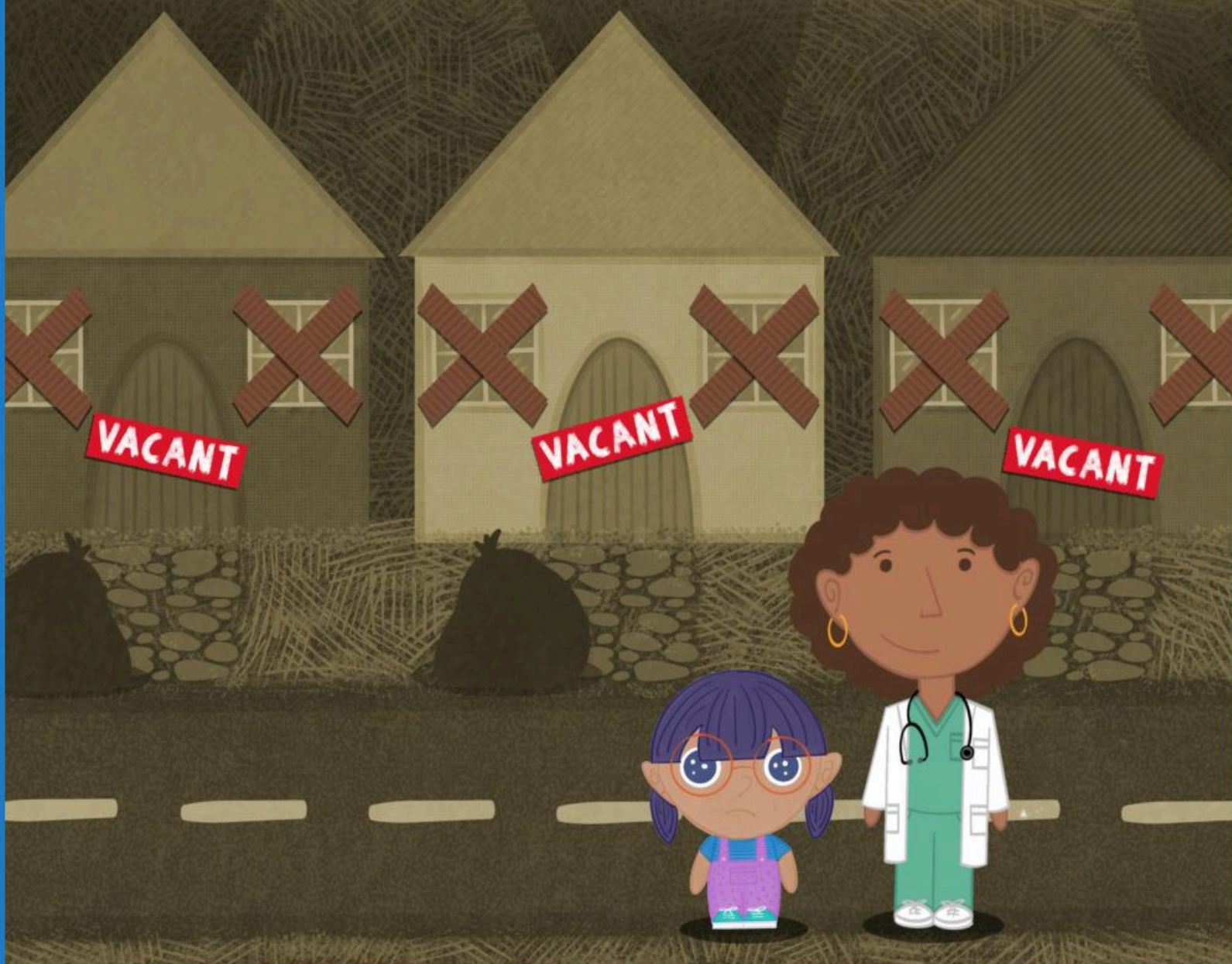


**“But MicroVille needs many different kinds of helpers,” said the doctor. “A city where everyone is the same would miss important talents.”**

**Mimi looked worried.**

**“My MicroVille doesn’t have enough neighbours?”**

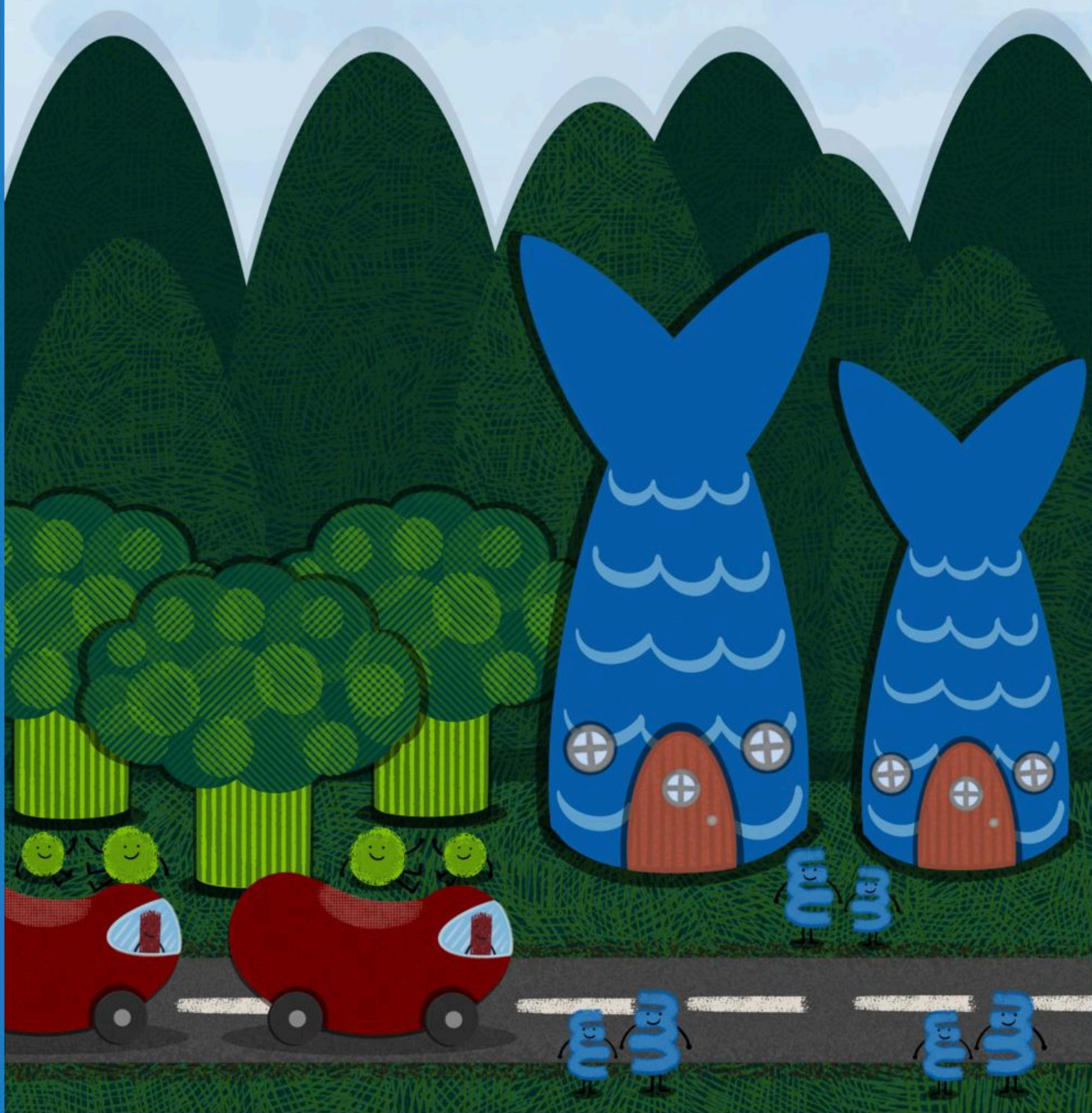
**“Not yet. But every meal is a chance to welcome someone new!”**



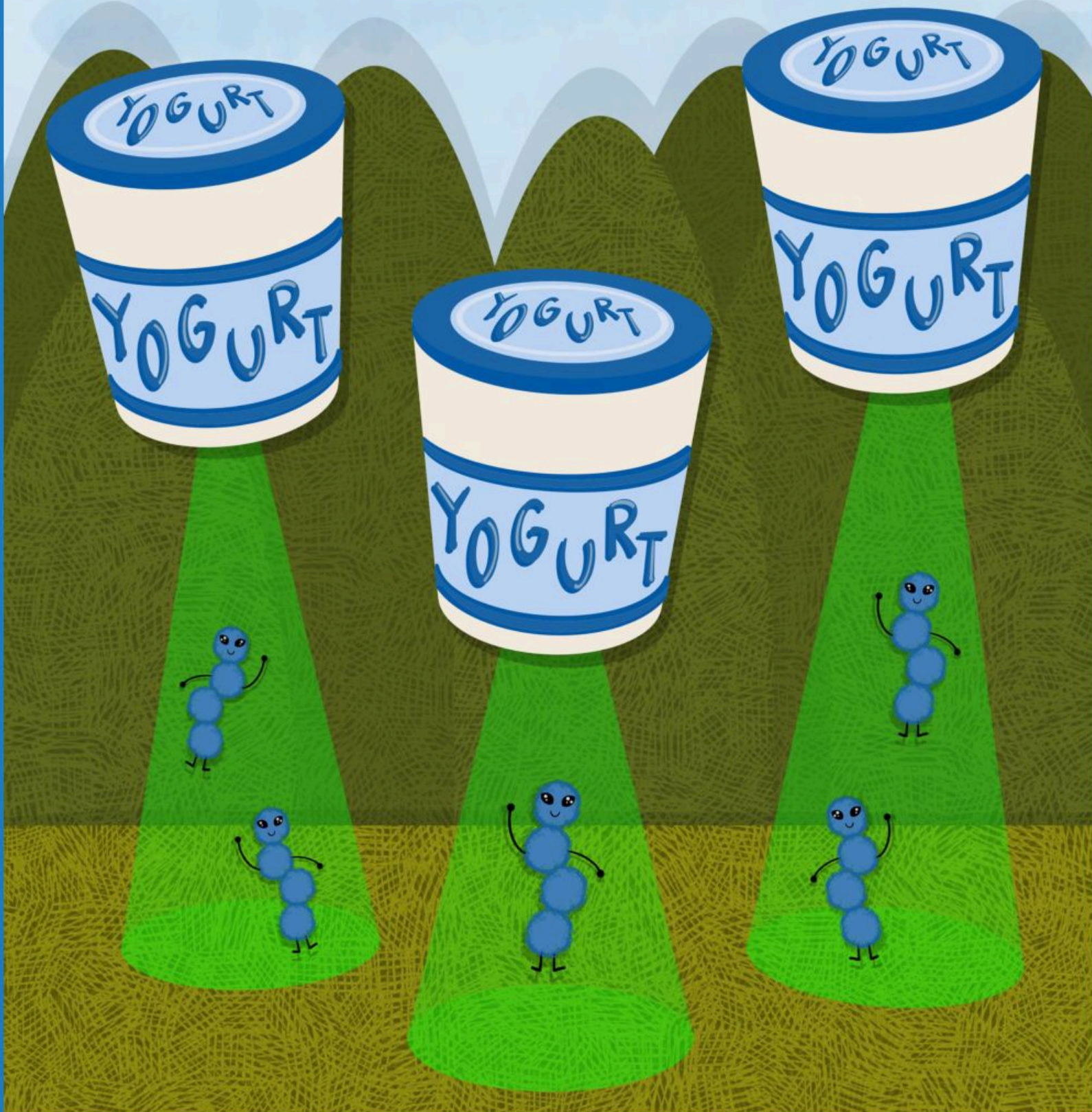
**So Mimi decided to try something new...  
She tasted a strawberry and inside MicroVille,  
a new group of helpers arrived!**



**Next came broccoli, beans, and fish.  
Each new food brought something different.  
And each new neighbour added  
something special.**



**Then Mimi tried yogurt  
and tiny spaceships landed in MicroVille.  
“Hello! We’re the Fermenters!”  
Finn Ferment exclaimed .**



**All of the microbes celebrated.  
“MicroVille is stronger because  
we are different!”**



**But one day, Mimi got sick.  
Inside MicroVille, things became a  
little harder. Some troublemakers  
tried to upset the balance.**



**But MicroVille worked together.**



**Penny protected.**

**Fiona supported.**



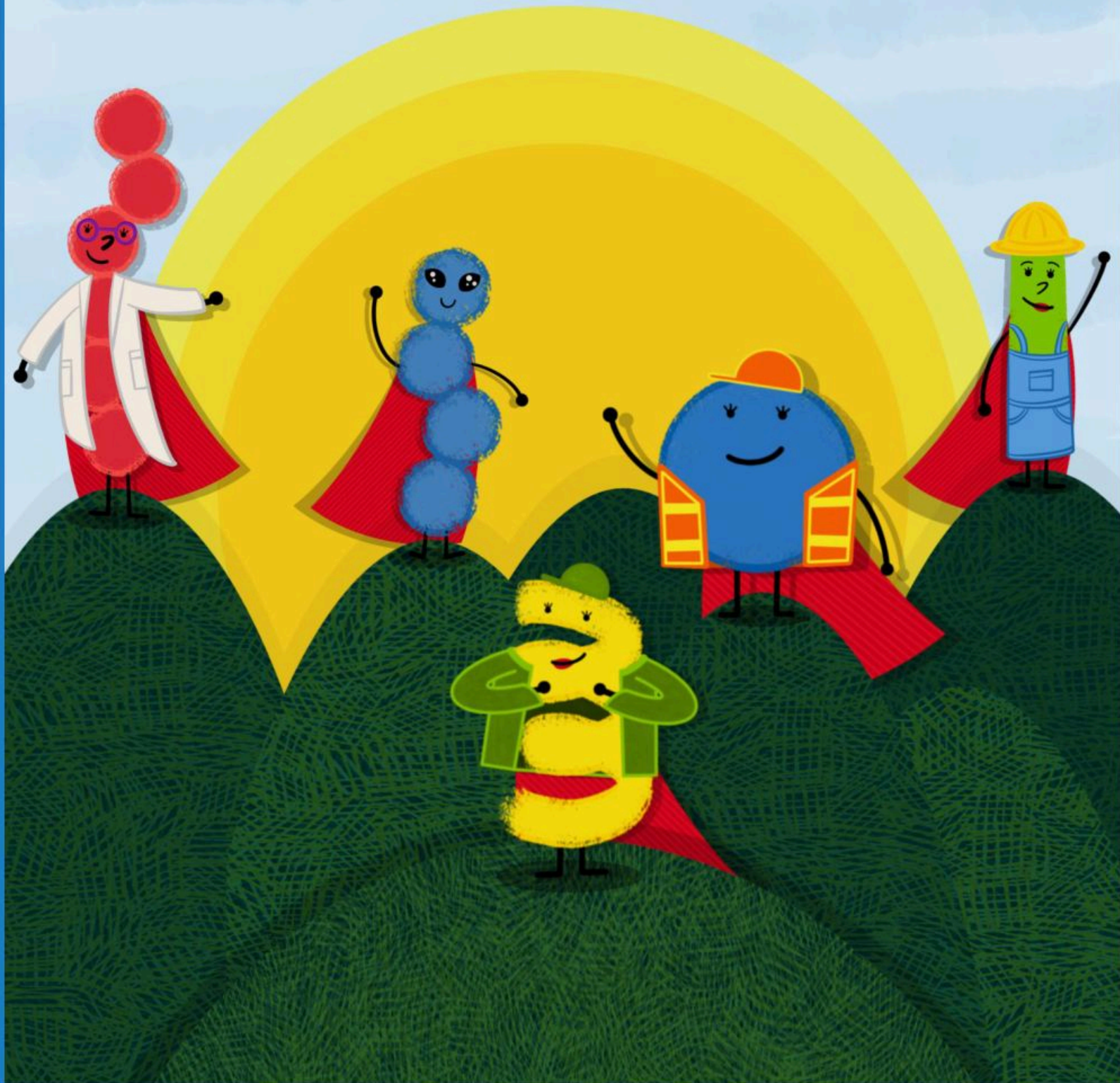
**Cleo cleaned.**



**Vita helped.**

**Everyone played an important part.**

**No single microbe saved the day.  
MicroVille was strongest because  
everybody contributed!**



**So being different is what makes  
my MicroVille special?**

**Yes Mimi! Every person  
has their own unique MicroVille.  
Every community is different.  
Every tiny neighbour matters!**



**“Welcome home!” said Mimi. “There’s a place for everyone in MicroVille!”**

Welcome To  
**—MICROVILLE—**

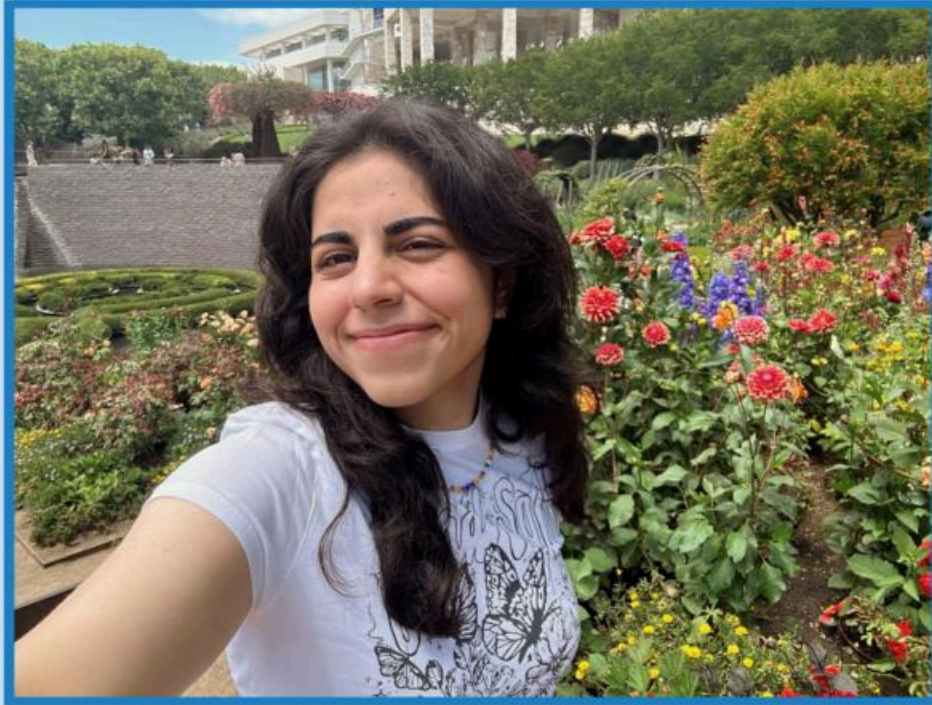


**The End.**

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## About the Author & Illustrator



**Bahareh Rahimi Shahmirzadi is a Microbiology and Immunology student at the University of Western Ontario and originally from London, Ontario. When she's not busy with school, she likes to watch movies, draw, and hang out with her friends and family.**



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